Secretary of State George P. Shultz and President Ronald Reagan on 29 July, followed by a banquet that night at the White House.

On her return from Washington on 31 July, there were three meetings at Carlyle Hotel, one with office bearers of various associations of persons of Indian origin, another with scientists, and a third with US businessmen of Indian origin. In the evening she was to watch a show at Broadway. On the morning of 1 August, there was the crucial (from my point of view) visit to Richmond Hill Gurudwara. At forenoon on 2 August, she was to receive the U Thant Award for encouraging cultural understanding between the East and West, followed by a call on the mayor of New York, Ed Koch. After that would follow a big contributory luncheon organized in her honour at the Waldorf-Astoria by the Foreign Policy Association, the Asia Society, the Far Eastern American Council of Commerce and Industry and the Indian Chamber of Commerce of America, where about 1,500 guests were expected to turn up. In the afternoon she was scheduled to leave for Los Angeles. [1]

On returning to my hotel room, I studied her programme carefully to prepare my action plan. Of all the listed functions I decided to focus on two – the meeting with prominent members of associations of persons of Indian origin on 31 July at Hotel Carlyle, and the visit to Richmond Hill Gurudwara on 95-30, 118th St South Richmond, Queens, on 1 August. For the function on 31 July, I sat in the hotel lobby and observed the guests walking into the hotel to attend the meetings. As expected, the function passed off peacefully.

In an interview to the *New York Times* on 31 July, Tejinder Singh Kahlon, president of the Sikh Cultural Society, which had invited Indira Gandhi to Richmond Gurudwara, described her impending visit as ‘an honour to us’. [2] She was expected to reach the gurudwara at 9.30 a.m. I reached about forty-five minutes before her arrival, which gave me enough time to have a close look at the premises and the kind of people who were coming to attend the function. For security reasons, only one entry with a small door was kept open, and was guarded heavily.